

THE YŌKAI CARDS

The creatures and apparitions of Kwaidan, named by what folklore calls them rather than by the title Hearn gave them. Cut along the lines.

HEIKÉ GHOSTS [VI] The drowned Taira dead of Dan-no-ura (1185), who summon a living reciter to perform their defeat for them. The Story of Mimi-Nashi-Hōichi	OSHIDORI SPIRIT [VI] The mandarin duck's widow, who appears in a dream as a woman and reproaches her husband's killer. Oshidori
REBIRTH (TENSHŌ) [VI] Not a creature: the return of a dead person's memory and promise in a living stranger. The Story of O-Tei; Riki Baka	TREE-SPIRIT (UBAZAKURA) [III] A cherry that blooms in a dead woman's stead on the day she died, having taken her life in exchange for a child's. Ubazakura
ONRYŌ (THREATENED) [VI] The vengeful ghost a condemned man promises to become — and, uniquely in this book, does not. Diplomacy	CURSED BELL / MUGEN-KANÉ An object rather than a being: a temple bell carrying a woman's shame, which grants a wish to whoever breaks it. Of a Mirror and a Bell
JIKININKI [III] A gaki — hungry ghost — condemned to eat corpses, formerly a priest who performed the rites for payment without belief. Jikininki	NOPPERA-BŌ [III] The faceless apparition. The word does not appear in Hearn's text; his title names the animal traditionally said to be wearing the disguise, which is never seen. Mujina
ROKURO-KUBI [III] Yōkai whose heads leave the body at night and hunt, the body left behind and vulnerable. That is Hearn's text: Kwairyō finds five bodies without heads and no blood, and the book he quotes says that a head which cannot find its body again will beat itself on the floor three times and die. Modern usage more often means the other kind — a neck that stretches to great length and stays attached. Both are called rokuro-kubi; this book has the first. Rokuro-Kubi	UNFINISHED DEAD [VI] A ghost that returns nightly not to harm but because one task is undone; laid by completing it. A Dead Secret

YUKI-ONNA [III] The Snow Woman. Kills by breath; spares by bargain; departs when the bargain is spoken of. Yuki-Onna	WILLOW-SPIRIT (AOYAGI) [III] A woman who is a willow tree, and who dies at the instant, and at the distance, of its felling. The Story of Aoyagi
TREE-SUBSTITUTION [III] A man dies by his own hand to give his life to a dying cherry, which blooms thereafter in the snow of the sixteenth day. Jiu-Roku-Zakura	ANT-KINGDOM [III] A dreamed lifetime of rule which proves, on waking, to have been an ant colony beneath a tree. The Dream of Akinosuké
HŌRAI Not a creature but a place: the isles of the blessed, described and then declared a mirage. Hōrai	

The bracketed numeral is the class the creature would take in Codex Bestiarius; the concordance sheet has the six classes in full.

From Kwaidan: Stories and Studies of Strange Things, Valice Classics 13. Free at valicepress.com/companion/kwaidan